

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an editorial from a computer gaming website:

Video games ARE art

Recently, a large news corporation published an article that attacks the heart of our computer games. Their claim is that video games do NOT transmit emotion to players. All of us who have ever finished a game know that this is entirely false.

The article says, 'As interesting as new games can be, they fall short of engaging the human heart. Games can be fun and rewarding in many ways, but they can't transmit the emotional complexity that is the root of art.' This is clearly ridiculous.

Who has not felt joy when a main character in a game falls in love? Who has not felt pain and sadness when a loved character dies? Who has not felt fear when facing the final battle?

Are movies considered art? YES. Music compositions, paintings, novels? YES. Then what are video games? They are much more than art. They are a perfect mixture of graphical art, musical soundtracks, gripping stories and one thing missing from traditional art forms: INTERACTIVITY. If we say that video games are not art, then there is no such thing as art, and we are denying all forms of art their true existence.

Your group wants to prepare for a debate on the topic *Computer games are beneficial for young people*. You are supporting the motion. You may want to talk about:

- why video games are considered art
- what benefits there are to playing computer games
- how you will argue against the other team's ideas
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. How do you feel when you play video games?
2. Is it more fun to play video games alone or with other people?
3. Why are video games so popular?
4. Is it okay if parents spend a lot of time playing video games?
5. Do you think characters are more interesting in a video game or in a film?
6. Do computer games bring people together or force them to be alone?
7. Do you think video games can truly engage players' emotions?
8. Do you think video games are as artistic as paintings?